- *Command-line interface (CLI)*—Use the CLI to call the AWS API from your terminal.
- *Software development kit (SDK)*—SDKs, available for most programming languages, make it easy to call the AWS API from your programming language of choice.
- *AWS CloudFormation*—Templates are used to describe the state of the infrastructure. AWS CloudFormation translates these templates into API calls.

Not all examples are covered by the Free Tier

The examples in this chapter are not all covered by the Free Tier. A special warning message appears when an example incurs costs. As for the other examples, as long as you don't run them longer than a few days, you won't pay anything. Keep in mind that this applies only if you created a fresh AWS account for this book and nothing else is going on in your AWS account. Try to complete the chapter within a few days; you'll clean up your account at the end.

On AWS, you control everything via an API. You interact with AWS by making calls to the REST API using the HTTPS protocol, as figure 4.1 illustrates. Everything is available through the API. You can start a virtual machine with a single API call, create 1 TB of storage, or start a Hadoop cluster over the API. By everything, we really mean *everything*. You'll need some time to understand the consequences. By the time you finish this book, you'll ask why the world wasn't always this easy.